2), as well as late-twentieth-century studies of nomadic groups in central Afghanistan, e.g., Glatzer and Casimir 1983 – the last study being especially pertinent as the same scholars documented and published the magnificent Shansabani *madrasa* of Shah-i Mashhad (Figure I.1) (Badghis province; discussed in Chapter 4) in the late 1960s while following the migration patterns of Pashtun nomads. Indeed, Najimi (2015: 147) noted the seasonal presence of the Achakzay nomads in the *madrasa*'s vicinity in recent years, continuing the migration patterns noted by Glatzer (1983). See also Thomas 2018: 26.

40. Comparable challenges exist for other nomadic elites, most notably the Saljuqs: cf., e.g., Durand-Guédy 2010: 70–71; and esp. Durand-Guédy 2013a for the interpretation of textual sources. Also Peacock 2010: 6–14; Peacock, 2015: 2–19; and Chapter 1.
41. Tapper 1997: 18ff.
42. See Paul 2018b: 316–318 for just such a juxtaposition of modern and historical nomadism in the vicinity of the Balkh oasis. Bosworth (1961: 118) noted, e.g., that: "After the Mongol invasions the pastoral element among the population [of Ghur] increased; whereas [earlier] the Tajik inhabitants … had been primarily agriculturalists"; but he provided no specific evidence for the statement, seeming to rely on the assumption that the nomadic Mongols would have introduced or strengthened ways of life akin to their own. But long- and short-term changes in climate have had obvious impacts on society as a whole, and should be one of the primary considerations in differentiating historical and contemporary realities. While comparative data from Europe on the "Medieval Warm Period" (*c.* 700–1300 CE) might provide points of departure, extrapolating larger global trends would be conjectural at best. Nonetheless, Thomas (2018: 28) summarized that: "[t]he decimation of Afghanistan's natural flora and fauna in recent decades … means that modern data cannot be viewed as representative of the Early Islamic period" (eighth–thirteenth centuries). A possible case of drastic change in the landscape – whether due to environmental factors, shifts in riverbeds or irrigation practices, or a combination of all three – is the region of Sistan: here Klaus Fischer, one of this region's most ardent and thorough investigators, noted an "unusual extent of ruins" compared with the sparseness of the modern population (Fischer 1969: 337). But a further observation, *viz.* "the majority of watch towers, fortresses, rural estates (*rustaq*), 'open towns' (cities without walls) situated in the plain and fortified cities existed from the beginning of the 12th to the end of the 15th cent. A.D.," was only scantily evidenced by surface findings, thus Sistan's architectural chronology has remained inconclusive. Cf. Fischer et al. vol. II, 1974: XII; Genito 2014; see also Chapters 1 and 2.
43. As highlighted by Mahmud (2009: 251–252), reiterating A. A. Kohzad's (e.g.,1951a, 1952, 1954a/b) observations during the course of his travels throughout Ghur in the 1950s. See also Thomas and Gascoigne 2016.
44. Sourdel-Thomine (1960: 280; my trans.) avowed that: "… [t]he art flourishing in Afghanistan during the sixth/twelfth century deserves above all the qualification of a post-Saljuqid Khurasani art developed from the traditions of the region …" For the northwestern Indo-Gangetic region, see esp.